

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12413168
Kind Code	B1
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Bertini; Anthony David et al.

Multiple output power supply for a movable barrier operator

Abstract

In one aspect, a movable barrier operator system is provided that includes a motor configured to be coupled to a movable barrier. The motor has a power rating indicative of a minimum power to be supplied to the motor in order for the motor to move the movable barrier. The system further includes an external power supply configured to connect to an electrical outlet. The external power supply has a plurality of outputs each having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the output supplies, the output power rating being less than the motor power rating. The movable barrier operator system includes combiner circuitry configured to combine power from the outputs of the external power supply and provide the combined power to the motor. The system further includes a monitoring circuit configured to detect a fault condition of any of the outputs of the external power supply.

Inventors: Bertini; Anthony David (Chicago, IL), Hertz; Edwin Fernelly Moreno (West Chicago, IL), Murray; James Scott (West Chicago, IL)

Applicant: The Chamberlain Group LLC (Oak Brook, IL)

Family ID: 90575887

Assignee: THE CHAMBERLAIN GROUP LLC. (Oak Brook, IL)

Appl. No.: 18/595545

Filed: March 05, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17130345 20201222 US 11955913 child-doc US 18595545

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H02P27/04 (20160101); E05F15/668 (20150101); H02P7/03 (20160101); H02P29/024 (20160101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H02P27/04 (20130101); E05F15/668 (20150115); H02P7/03 (20160201); H02P29/0241 (20160201); E05Y2201/434 (20130101); E05Y2400/61 (20130101); E05Y2900/106 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: E05F (15/668); H02P (27/04); H02P (29/0241); H02P (29/024); H02P (7/03)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
10731397	12/2019	Tsui	N/A	E05F 15/681
11187026	12/2020	Cate	N/A	E05F 15/77
11261648	12/2021	Axtolis	N/A	E05F 15/41
11574512	12/2022	Morris	N/A	E05F 15/77
11955913	12/2023	Bertini	N/A	H02P 29/0241

Primary Examiner: Dinh; Thai T

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Dority & Manning, P.A.

Background/Summary

(1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/130,345, filed Dec. 22, 2020, entitled MULTIPLE OUTPUT POWER SUPPLY FOR A MOVABLE BARRIER OPERATOR.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure relates generally to movable barrier operators, and more specifically, to power supplies for movable barrier operators, such as residential garage door openers.

BACKGROUND

(2) A movable barrier operator (MBO) may be used to control access to areas by moving movable barriers between different positions. For example, a jackshaft-style movable barrier operator may be installed in a secured area (e.g., a warehouse or garage) to control the position of a movable door. The jackshaft operator generally includes an output shaft connected to a counterweight shaft of the movable door. The counterweight shaft is connected to a torsion spring that balances most of the weight of the door. To control the position of the door, the movable door includes drums mounted on the output shaft and a pair of cables each connected at one end to the drum and at an opposite end to the door. The jackshaft operator turns the output shaft, causing rotation of the drums to either wind up or pay out the cables from the drums and thereby move the door. Movable barrier operators, including jackshaft-style operators, may be subject to certifications, regulatory approval or restrictions related to the class of power and current (VA class ratings) that are supplied to power the movable barrier operator as well as the cabling or wiring used to connect the movable

barrier operator to a power source.

(3) The Underwriters Laboratory (UL) 325 Standard, for example, specifies a 120 Volt alternating current (AC) residential garage operator to have an AC power cord length of 6 feet or less. The National Electrical Code (NEC) further specifies that a 120 Volt AC extension cord may not be secured to a surface (e.g., a wall). In many homes or residences, there are no electrical outlets provided within 6 feet of the location of where a jackshaft-operator is mounted. As a result, to power a jackshaft operator in accordance with the UL and NEC specifications a 120 VAC outlet should be installed within the 6 feet of a planned installation location of a jackshaft operator. For those homeowners who are not handy or comfortable with a do-it-yourself (DIY) addition of a new electrical outlet and circuitry, this additional installation is expensive and can cost more than the MBO system itself. In addition, the need to engage an electrician, adds time and inconvenience to the customer and/or the installer of the jackshaft operator, making the overall system installation process more challenging.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Disclosed herein are embodiments of systems, apparatuses, and methods pertaining to movable barrier operators, including their components, operation and installation. This description includes drawings, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 is an illustration of an example movable barrier operator system within a garage.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an example movable barrier operator system including a movable barrier operator and an external power supply.

(4) FIG. 3 shows a plurality of outputs of an example external power supply coupled to the movable barrier operator.

(5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating an example monitoring circuit of a movable barrier operator.

(6) FIG. 5 is a flow chart of an example method of installing a movable barrier system.

(7) FIG. 6 is a flow chart of an example method of operating a movable barrier system.

(8) FIG. 7 is a flow chart of another example method of operating a movable barrier system.

(9) Elements in the figures are illustrated for simplicity and clarity and have not necessarily been drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions and/or relative positioning of some of the elements in the figures may be exaggerated relative to other elements to help to improve understanding of various embodiments of the present invention. Also, common but well-understood elements that are useful or necessary in a commercially feasible embodiment are often not depicted in order to facilitate a less obstructed view of these various embodiments of the present invention. Certain actions and/or steps may be described or depicted in a particular order of occurrence while those skilled in the art will understand that such specificity with respect to sequence is not actually required. The terms and expressions used herein have the ordinary technical meaning as is accorded to such terms and expressions by persons skilled in the technical field as set forth above except where different specific meanings have otherwise been set forth herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) In accordance with one aspect of the present disclosure, a movable barrier operator system is provided that includes a motor configured to be coupled to a movable barrier and move the movable barrier between open and closed positions. The motor has a power rating indicative of a recommended electrical power to be supplied to the motor in order for the motor to move the movable barrier. The system further includes an external power supply configured to connect to an electrical outlet. The external power supply has a plurality of outputs with each output of the plurality having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the individual output supplies, the

individual output power rating of each output being less than the motor power rating. The movable barrier operator system includes combiner circuitry configured to combine power from the outputs of the external power supply and provide the combined power to the motor. The system further includes a monitoring circuit configured to detect a fault condition of any of the outputs of the external power supply.

(11) The present movable barrier operator system provides enhanced flexibility during installation because, in some embodiments, the lower power rating of the outputs of the external power supply permits wiring of the outputs to be secured to a surface (e.g., ceiling or wall) where wiring having a power rating commensurate with the motor may not otherwise be specified, recommended or permitted to be secured. For example, the motor may have a NEC Class I power rating and the outputs of the external power supply include wiring having a NEC Class 2 power rating. In this manner, the outputs of the wiring may have a lower power rating such that the wiring may be secured directly (e.g., without conduit or raceway) to a wall while complying with NEC specifications since the NEC is permissive toward Class 2 wiring to be secured to a wall.

(12) The present disclosure also provides a method of operating a movable barrier operator system including a movable barrier operator and an external power supply. The example method includes providing electrical power to the movable barrier operator via a plurality of outputs of the external power supply and monitoring each output of the external power supply for a fault. The method further includes combining the electrical power from the outputs of the external power supply at current combiner circuitry of the movable barrier operator and providing an electrical power output from the current combiner circuitry to a motor of the movable barrier operator. The combined electrical power output from the current combiner circuitry is greater than the power supplied individually by each of the outputs of the power supply. In this manner, the outputs of the external power supply combine to provide the electrical power for the movable barrier operator to move an associated movable barrier while the outputs may include wiring having a lower power rating (e.g., Class 2) than the power rating of the movable barrier operator (e.g., Class 1). The lower power rating of the outputs of the external power supply may permit more installation configurations than if the outputs were a higher power rating and subject to more particular installation recommendations.

(13) In accordance with another aspect of the present disclosure, a method is provided for installing a movable barrier operator system. The method includes mounting a movable barrier operator to a surface of a secured area and coupling a motor of the movable barrier operator to a movable barrier. The movable barrier operator has a power rating indicative of a minimum power to be supplied to the movable barrier operator in order for the movable barrier operator to move the movable barrier. The method further includes connecting an external power supply for the movable barrier operator to an electrical outlet, the external power supply including a plurality of outputs configured to supply electrical power to the movable barrier operator, each of the outputs having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the output provides that is less than the power rating of the movable barrier operator. The method facilitates a variety of installation configurations of the movable barrier operator system due to the lower power rating of the outputs of the external power supply as discussed in greater detail below.

(14) The present disclosure also provides systems, devices, and methods are provided herein useful to install and operate a movable barrier operator. More specifically, a multi-output external power supply is provided that allows a movable barrier system with a volt-ampere (VA) rating (e.g., Class 1) to be energized by an external power supply whose $n+1$ outputs (i.e., $n+1$ operator inputs) have a different VA rating (e.g., Class 2). Because a plurality of inputs to the operator are wired and installed, a monitoring circuit is also provided that is configured to monitor for an electrical characteristic or parameter (e.g., determine voltage and current levels of then $+1$ Class 2 rated inputs) of the external power supply, to assess if the operator was installed according to recommendations and/or instructions and has a suitable voltage/current supply for operation. In

addition to validation of the setup and wiring during initialization, the monitoring circuit may also provide a determination of a fault condition continuously and/or at scheduled time intervals. A fault may be, for example, improper connection of one or more of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply or inputs of the movable barrier operator, excess voltage or current load on one or more of the plurality of outputs and/or inputs, and/or failure of one or more of the plurality of outputs and/or inputs.

(15) In some embodiments, a movable barrier operator system comprises a movable barrier operator, such as a jackshaft operator, having a motor for moving a movable barrier from an open to a closed position. The system also includes an external power supply having a plurality of outputs, the external power supply configured to be coupled to the movable barrier operator for supplying a target voltage and amperage to the movable barrier operator. The system also includes a monitoring circuit for detecting faults of the external power supply and/or connections between the external power supply and the movable barrier operator. Each of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply may have a common VA rating, and the plurality of outputs are combined to supply a target voltage and/or current at a different VA rating to the operator for running the motor. A target voltage/current to power the motor may be in the range of up to 20 Volts and up to 24 Amps. A common voltage/current supplied by the outputs may be in the range of up to 20 Volts and up to 8 Amps.

(16) In other embodiments, a method of installing a movable barrier operator system is provided. The movable barrier operator system includes a movable barrier operator, an external power supply having multiple outputs configured to be connected to the movable barrier operator, and combiner circuitry configured to combine the power from the outputs of the external power supply for use by the movable barrier operator. The method includes monitoring the system to determine if a fault condition is present. If a fault condition is present, an alert may be provided to signal or prompt an action to address the fault. The action may be predetermined or otherwise previously suggested. Such action may be based on the type of fault, and different types of alerts or alarms may be used to signal different fault conditions and may suggest the relevant appropriate action to resolve it. Once the action is performed, the system may be monitored again to check for additional faults or issues until there is a no-fault condition or state. Once no fault is detected, the movable barrier operator may be tested for overall operation, and the installation and initialization of the movable barrier operator system may be completed. Testing and completion may include, for example, mounting of any remaining components, final testing of the movement and control of the garage door, etc. Monitoring by the monitoring circuit may continue to occur subsequent to an initialization phase and may occur continuously, periodically, randomly, or regularly at scheduled intervals. If a fault is detected after the initialization phase, alternative actions may be taken. For example, an alert or alarm may be sent to a user indicating the presence of a system issue, and a backup battery may be engaged if a fault is detected in one of the plurality of outputs as one example.

(17) In yet other embodiments, a method of operating a movable barrier operator system is provided. The method comprises providing an operator for lifting a movable barrier between an open and a closed position. The method also includes using an external power supply with a plurality of outputs having VA ratings, and supplying power to the operator at a target VA rating. The method also includes monitoring each of the plurality of outputs to determine if a fault is detected from the external power supply. The plurality of outputs are combined to supply power to the movable barrier operator where the target rating is different from the VA ratings of the outputs of the external power supply.

(18) The embodiments herein provide a number of improvements as will become apparent from the description that follows. An advantage of one embodiment is that the operator may be installed in a location within a garage where an AC outlet (e.g., 120 V) and the movable barrier operator are not within 6 ft of each other. More specifically, the installation of a movable barrier operator may be

greater than 6 feet from an AC outlet. In addition, combining a plurality of outputs having a lower VA class rating (e.g., Class 2) coming from an external power supply, enables an overall higher VA rated system (e.g., Class 1) for installation and regulatory purposes, while utilizing cabling at the lower VA class rating. As such, wires of the outputs may be fastened to a garage interior wall and/or ceiling where the wires are Class 2, even though the system is Class 1, and such Class 2 power wires may accordingly be longer than 6 feet.

(19) With reference to FIG. 1, an example movable barrier operator system **10** is provided that includes a movable barrier operator **100**, such as a garage door opener. The movable barrier operator **100** is configured to move a door of a movable barrier between open and closed positions. The movable barrier may include a door, such as a garage door **105**, and components that facilitate movement of the door such as drums **115**, **120** and flexible drive members such as chains or cables **125**, **130**. The movable barrier operator **100** may be configured to move the garage door **105** in response to commands from one or more remote controls such as portable transmitters, a keypad, an in-vehicle transmitter, a wall controller and/or portable electronic device directly or over a network.

(20) The movable barrier operator **100** may be in the form of a jackshaft-style operator as provided in the example shown in FIG. 1. While a jackshaft-style operator is shown and used as a common example in this disclosure, the subject matter of this disclosure can be employed in other movable barrier operator systems such as garage door opener systems that use a trolley. The movable barrier operator **100** includes a motor **110** (see FIG. 2). The motor **110** has an output shaft coupled to a drive shaft **111** that may also be referred to as a torsion shaft or the jackshaft. The drums **115**, **120** are mounted to the drive shaft **111** and are connected to the cables **125**, **130**. The motor **110** is configured to turn the drive shaft **111** and drums **115**, **120** to wind the cables **125**, **130** onto or pay off the cables **125**, **130** from the drums **115**, **120**. The motor **110** may be a component of a variable speed drive of the movable barrier operator **100**. The variable speed drive may permit changing of the speed of the motor **110** such as by changing the frequency of electrical power utilized by the motor **110**. The motor **110** may have one or more variables associated with operation of the motor **110** such as the frequency of electrical power utilized by the motor **110**, current draw of the motor **110**, and/or speed of the motor **110**.

(21) As illustrated, the garage door **105** is in a closed position. When the movable barrier operator **100** receives a command to open the garage door **105**, the movable barrier operator **100** operates the motor **110** to turn the drive shaft **111** and the cable drums **115**, **120**. The cable drums **115**, **120** rotate and wind the cables **125**, **130** which are connected to bottom portions of the door **105** around the cable drums **115**, **120**. This winding up of the cables **125**, **130** causes the garage door **105** to move upward and into an open position.

(22) Once the garage door **105** is in an open position, the garage door **105** is oriented substantially horizontally on horizontal portions **135** of tracks **136** that guide movements of the garage door **105**. When the movable barrier operator **100** receives a command to move the garage door **105** to a closed position, the movable barrier operator **100** operates the motor **110** in the opposite direction. This causes the cables **125**, **130** to unwind or pay out from the cable drums **115**, **120**, and allows the garage door **105** to move downward by gravity along vertical portions **140** of the guide tracks **136**, being controllably lowered by the cables **125**, **130**.

(23) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an example movable barrier operator system **200**, in accordance with some embodiments. The movable barrier operator system **200** includes a movable barrier operator **100**, an external power supply **270**, and a monitoring circuit **280**. The movable barrier operator **100** may include a motor **110**, a controller **250** that includes a processor or processing circuitry **260** and a memory **240**. The motor **110** may be a component of a variable speed drive of the movable barrier operator **100**. In an embodiment, a changing in the speed of the motor **110** may be performed by changing the frequency of electrical power utilized by the motor **110**. For example, the frequency may be adjusted within the range of approximately 30 hertz to

approximately 120 hertz.

(24) The movable barrier operator **100** includes a backup battery **170** that may be utilized to power the movable barrier operator **100** if a fault is detected in one of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply **270** or when an electrical power source (e.g., an AC power outlet or line to which the external power supply **270** is coupled) is interrupted. The backup battery **170** may be rechargeable. The movable barrier operator **100** includes a battery charger **170A** that receives power from the combiner circuitry **230** when the motor **110** is not being operated to charge the backup battery **170** when the backup battery is not fully charged. Once fully charged, the battery charger **170A** may monitor the status of the backup battery **170** and charge the backup battery **170** as needed to maintain a predetermined amount of stored energy in the backup battery **170**.

(25) The movable barrier operator **100** also includes communication circuitry **220**, which may be configured to communicate with a sensor **225** of the movable barrier operator system **200**. The sensor **225** may include one or more sensors, such as an optical obstruction detector (e.g., photoeyes and/or a camera), a torque or output shaft speed (e.g., RPM) sensor associated with the motor **110**, and/or a motion sensor. In addition, the movable barrier operator **100** communicates with a movable barrier operator server computer **210** over a network **215** using the communication circuitry **220**. In some examples, the communication circuitry **220** may communicate door status (open, closed, moving), obstruction, and power supply information to the server computer **110** and receives state change commands from the server computer **110**. The network **215** may include one or more networks, for example, a wireless access point and the internet.

(26) The movable barrier operator **100** may be controlled by a remote control **205**, such as a hand-held transmitter, an in-vehicle device, or a portable electronic device (e.g., a smartphone). The hand-held transmitter may communicate directly with the movable barrier operator **100**, for example, via a 300-400 or 900 MHz radio signal. The portable electronic device **205** may additionally or alternatively communicate indirectly with the movable barrier operator **100**. For example, a state change request (e.g., open or close the garage door) may be sent from the remote control device **205** to the server computer **210** over the network **215** (e.g., the internet) and the server computer **210** may communicate a state change command over the network **215** to the movable barrier operator **100**.

(27) The movable barrier operator **100** may also include combiner circuitry **230**, which combines one or more of the power, the current and/or voltage of a plurality of outputs (e.g., outputs **290A-C** of FIGS. **3** and **4**) of the external power supply **270** into a single input for use by the movable barrier operator **100**. The outputs **290A-C** may include wires preassembled with the other components of the external power supply **270** such as being soldered to or otherwise integral/unitary with electrical conductors or terminals of the AC to low voltage (LV) DC circuitry **320A-C**. In another embodiment, the outputs **290A-C** are connectors of the external power supply **270**, and an installer customizes the various conductors between movable barrier operator **100** and external power supply **270** (e.g., by cut wires to length and then connecting the wires to the connectors, or otherwise selecting certain pre-configured wires/conductors of, for example, a set or kit) during installation of the movable barrier operator system **10**.

(28) The outputs **290** may be two or more outputs, such as output **290A**, **290B** . . . **290N**. The combiner circuitry **230** may be located within movable barrier operator **100** as illustrated. Alternatively, the combiner circuitry **230** may be provided external to the movable barrier operator **100**. Each of the outputs **290A-C** have a power/volt-amp (VA) rating in a first voltage/current rating category (e.g., Class 2), and are combined to supply a target voltage to the movable barrier operator **100** at a higher target voltage/current rating (e.g., Class 1). Examples of the connection and operation of an external power supply **270** according to some embodiments herein will be discussed in further detail hereinafter.

(29) A monitoring circuit **280** may also be coupled to, or integral with, the movable barrier operator **100** for monitoring the installation and operation of the external power supply **270** and the

configuration of the outputs **290A-C**. More particularly, the monitoring circuit **280** may be configured to monitor and detect a fault condition in the operation or installation of the external power supply **270**. A fault condition may signify the result of a complete failure of one of the outputs **290A-C** or other components of the movable barrier operator **100**. As another example, a detected fault condition may signify an installation miswiring, improper load sharing, a short-circuit, an open-circuit, or other persistent or intermittent problem, issue or defect in the movable barrier operator **100** or the external power supply **270**. Other embodiments of the monitoring circuit will be described in further detail below with respect to FIG. 4.

(30) FIG. 3 is block diagram of an example movable barrier operator system **300**, which may be similar to system **200** of FIG. 2, where the plurality of outputs **290A-C** of an external power supply (EPS) **270** are provided to movable barrier operator **100**, in accordance with some embodiments. As illustrated, the external power supply **270** may include AC protection circuitry **330** and a cord **315** for connecting to an outlet **340** (e.g., 120 VAC receptacle). In some instances, the cord **315** may be omitted such that the EPS **270** includes a plug **345** and/or receptacle-engaging members **335** (e.g., prongs or blades) for directly coupling the EPS **270** to the outlet **340**. The external power supply **270** may also include a plurality of AC to DC circuitry **320A-C**, each associated with respective outputs **290A-C**. As shown, the outputs **290A-C** are configured as pairs of conductors, however additional conductors may be employed. The AC to DC circuitry **320A-C** converts the AC input received from the outlet **340** to a DC output for each of the pairs **290A**, **290B**, **290C** of outputs **290A-C**. Each of the pairs **290A**, **290B**, **290C** may be bundled together first, and then the outputs **290A-C** may be combined within a single jacket. Alternatively, all the outputs **290A-C** may be bundled in a single jacket without jacketing each pair **290A**, **290B**, **290C**.

(31) In an embodiment, the external power supply **270** transforms an input power (e.g., a 120 VAC power supply) to a lower voltage and current. In the embodiment of FIG. 3, the external power supply **270** may be installed using an existing 120 VAC outlet **340** within the garage. In contrast, conventional systems would entail installation of a new 120 VAC outlet **340** proximate to the movable barrier operator. Further, each of the plurality of outputs **290A-C** of the external power supply **270** have Class 2 output power, and thus can be wired from the external power supply **270** to the movable barrier operator **100** and secured to a garage's interior wall or ceiling.

(32) In this exemplary embodiment, there are three outputs **290A-C**. Each output **290A-C** includes two wires **310**, each wire **310** for providing a positive or negative voltage. In other words, there are three pairs of positive and negative wires. The outputs **290A-C** have a Class 2 rating and are combined using combiner circuitry **230** to supply a Class 1 input to the movable barrier operator **100** for supplying power to the motor **110**. As noted previously, the combiner circuitry **230** may be a component of the operator **100** or external to the operator **100**. In an embodiment, the motor **110** when energized operates at 18 VDC and 15 A (i.e., 270 W), and the NEC Class 2 specification has a 5 A max for a circuit less than 20 VDC. In this instance, according to some embodiments herein, the external power supply **270** would have three outputs **290A-C**, each having a 5 A, 18 VDC max rating, where each of the 18 V paired output conductors **290A**, **290B**, **290C** meets the Class 2 definition or specification, and are combined by the combiner circuitry **230** to yield or otherwise form an 18 V, 15 A (i.e., 270 W) power source to the motor **110**. One of ordinary skill in the art would appreciate that the specific Class, and specifications or requirements associated therewith do not limit the scope of this invention to the exemplary embodiments described herein.

(33) The movable barrier operator **100** may include an interface **354** to which the wires **310** of the outputs **290A-C** are connected. For example, the interface **354** may include a block, backplane, or a socket having electrical contacts or terminal connection points. The external power supply **270** may include a connector **355**, such as a plug, having the wires **310** secured permanently thereto and electrical contacts in communication with the wires **310**. The interface **354** and connector **355** may be shaped so that the interface **354** and connector **355** may be connected together in only one orientation which inhibits miswiring of the system **300**. Once the interface **354** and connector **355**

are connected together, the electrical contacts thereof are in contact and conduct electricity between the wires **310** and the combiner circuitry **230**. In another embodiment, the outputs **290A-C** may be coupled to the movable barrier operator **100** via a direct connection to a circuit board of the movable barrier operator **100**. In yet another example, the outputs **290A-C** may be connected to a terminal block of the movable barrier operator **100**.

(34) Regarding FIG. 4, the external power supply **270** provides a monitoring circuit **400** with a N number of inputs, namely outputs **290A-N** from the external power supply **270**. Each of the outputs **290A-N** from the external power supply **270** are coupled to a respective voltage/current monitor **420A-N** that determines whether an acceptable current and/or voltage is being supplied by the associated output **290A-N**. The voltage/current monitor **420A-N** is coupled to a microprocessor **440**, which is configured to provide an appropriate alert relating to whether proper or improper function is occurring during installation and/or operation.

(35) In addition, the monitoring circuit **400** includes at least one blocking diode **410A-N** associated with each output **290A-N**. The blocking diodes **410A-C** operate to protect the outputs **290A-N** from one another. More particularly, each of the N outputs **290A-N** are put through a low voltage drop blocking diode **410** which prevents back-feeding power from one output **290A-N** to another. After passing through the diodes **410A-N** of the monitoring circuit **400**, there are N outputs **450A-N**, which are then combined into one combined input **441** by the combiner circuitry **430** to provide power to the operator **100**. In an embodiment, the combiner circuitry **430** may be provided within the monitoring circuit **400**, as illustrated in FIG. 4. Furthermore, the monitoring circuitry **400** and the combiner circuitry **430** may be configured to be integral, unitary or otherwise within the movable barrier operator **100**. The combiner circuitry **430** serves as a point at which all outputs **450A-N** recombine to satisfy the power demands of the motor **110** of the operator **100** (e.g., Class 1 VA requirements).

(36) In an embodiment, the outputs **290A-N** are monitored individually by the monitoring circuit **400**, which sends a level appropriate signal to a microprocessor **440**. Microprocessor **440** may be a single microprocessor. In an embodiment, there are a plurality of microprocessors **440**, each dedicated to a given output **290A-N**. The signal indicates to the microprocessor **440** that an output **290A-N** is energized. The microprocessor **440** may be programmed to operate as an AND gate. Specifically, if all N outputs **290A-N** have a true reading on them, then the monitoring circuit **400** considers the Class 1 input **441** to be functioning correctly. Microprocessor **440** may be the same as processor **260**. Alternatively, microprocessor **440** may be one or more separate processors.

(37) In an embodiment, the monitoring circuit **400** is configured to provide additional fault detection for various movable barrier systems herein. For example, one-way or two-way communication between the monitoring circuit **400** and the external power supply **270** may be facilitated via a communication channel (e.g., LIN, BTLE, Wi-Fi, etc.). In one embodiment, the monitoring circuit **280** is a component of the movable barrier operator **100** and the external power supply **270** includes a microprocessor **371** and communication circuitry **373**. The microprocessor **371** may monitor for faults and, in response to a fault, cause the communication circuitry **373** to send a signal to the movable barrier operator **100** indicating the fault. In another approach, the microprocessor **371** may cause the communication circuitry **373** to send periodic signals indicating proper functioning of the external power supply **270**. Upon the microprocessor **371** detecting a fault, or upon failure of the external power supply **270**, the communication circuitry **373** no longer sends periodic signals indicating proper functioning and the movable barrier operator **100** may determine a fault has occurred.

(38) Further, one or both of the microprocessor **371** and the monitoring circuit **280** cause a boot-up protocol to be performed to check whether all of the outputs of the external power supply are wired correctly. For example, and with reference to FIG. 4, a boot-up protocol may executed by the monitoring circuit **400** wherein the monitoring circuit **400** instructs the external power supply **270** to sequentially test the outputs **290** of the external power supply **270** by energizing the output **290**

being tested and deenergizing the outputs not being tested. More specifically, the microprocessor **371** of the external power supply **270** causes the AC to LV DC circuitry **320A** to energize the wires **310** of output **290A** while deenergizing the AC to LV DC circuitry **320B** and **320C**. By deenergize, it is intended that the microprocessor **371** may turn off, or keep off, the AC to LV DC circuitry **320B** and **320C**. If the output **290A** is connected properly, only voltage/current monitor **420A** should detect a voltage or current of the output **290A**.

(39) If an output **290** has an element electrically coupled to one of the other inputs of the combiner circuitry **230**, the voltage/current monitor **420** (for example voltage/current monitor **420B**) of the other input will detect a voltage or current. The detection of a current, voltage, or power of an output **290** other than the output **290** energized by the microprocessor **371** indicates a fault with the energized output **290**. The process of energizing one of the outputs **290** while deenergizing the other outputs **290** may be repeated for the rest of the N number outputs **290** to determine if there are faults with any of the outputs **290**. In an embodiment, for each output **290** energized, there may be only one V/A/W detected at the voltage/current monitor **420**, such that once all outputs **290** are tested, voltage/current at each voltage/current monitor **420** has been detected only one time. Thus, it may be possible to wire one of the outputs **290A-N** to any single input of a voltage/current monitor **420**, such that only one of the outputs **290A-N** may be wired to any single voltage/current monitor **420** and a single voltage/current monitor **420** has only one of the outputs **290A-N** wired to it.

(40) Some embodiments of the boot-up protocol may be executed by a method or computer-based device having stored instructions related to the protocol on a non-transitory computer readable medium having that, when executed by a processor, cause the monitoring circuit **400** to perform the protocol steps.

(41) Regarding FIG. 5, a method **500** is provided for installing a movable barrier system, in accordance with some embodiments. The method **500** includes mounting **502** a movable barrier operator, such as movable barrier operator **100**, to a surface of a secured area. The movable barrier operator has a power rating indicative of a minimum power to be supplied to the movable barrier operator in order for the movable barrier operator to move the movable barrier. Mounting **502** may include mounting the movable barrier operator to a wall or a ceiling of the secured area.

(42) The method **500** includes coupling **504** a motor of the movable barrier operator to a movable barrier. The movable barrier operator may be, for example, a jackshaft operator and coupling **504** includes coupling an output shaft of the movable barrier operator that is driven by the motor to a torsion bar of the movable barrier.

(43) The method **500** includes connecting **506** an external power supply for the movable barrier operator to an electrical outlet. The external power supply includes a plurality of outputs configured to supply electrical power to the movable barrier operator, each of the outputs having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the output provides that is less than the power rating of the movable barrier operator. The connecting **506** may include monitoring whether a fault is present in one or more of the outputs of the external power supply. If no fault is detected, the method **500** may proceed to other installation operations such as setting forces and/or door movement limits. If a fault is detected, the method **500** may further include communicating an alert indicating the fault to a user. Once action is taken by the user responsive to the alert, the system is again monitored and the system checks again to see if a fault is detected. Once no faults are detected, the method **500** may proceed to subsequent installation procedures.

(44) Regarding FIG. 6, a method **600** is provided for operating a movable barrier system, in accordance with some embodiments. The method **600** includes providing **602** electrical power to the movable barrier operator via a plurality of outputs of the external power supply and monitoring **604** each output of the external power supply for a fault. If a fault is detected, the method **600** may include communicating an alert to a user device indicating the fault. The alert may include instructions for taking an action or troubleshooting. Alternatively or additionally, the method **602**

may include disconnecting the external power supply from the movable barrier operator. A backup battery of the movable barrier operator may then be used to power the movable barrier operator until the fault is remedied.

(45) The method **600** further includes combining **606** the electrical power from the outputs of the external power supply at current combiner circuitry of the movable barrier operator. The method **600** further includes providing **608** an electrical power output from the current combiner circuitry to a motor of the movable barrier operator. The electrical power output from the current combiner circuitry is greater than the power supplied by a single one of the outputs of the power supply.

(46) Regarding FIG. 7, a method **700** is provided for operating a movable barrier system, in accordance with some embodiments. In an embodiment, the method **700** includes combining **702** electrical power supplied from a plurality of outputs of an external power supply using current combiner circuitry of a movable barrier operator to obtain a combined electrical power output. The method **700** further includes providing **704** the combined electrical power output to power the movable barrier operator. The method **600** further includes operating **706** a motor of the movable barrier operator, the combined electrical power output being greater than the electrical power supplied individually by each of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply. The method **700** further includes monitoring **708** each output of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply for a fault.

(47) In other embodiments, the method includes providing electrical power to the movable barrier operator via a plurality of outputs of the external power supply and monitoring each output of the external power supply for a fault. If a fault is detected, the method may include communicating an alert to a user device indicating the fault. The alert may include instructions for taking an action or troubleshooting. Alternatively or additionally, the method may include disconnecting the external power supply from the movable barrier operator. A backup battery of the movable barrier operator may then be used to power the movable barrier operator until the fault is remedied.

(48) The method further includes combining the electrical power from the outputs of the external power supply at current combiner circuitry of the movable barrier operator. The method further includes providing an electrical power output from the current combiner circuitry to a motor of the movable barrier operator. The electrical power output from the current combiner circuitry is greater than the power supplied by the outputs of the power supply.

(49) In another embodiment, a method of installing a movable barrier operator system is provided. The method comprises: mounting a movable barrier operator to a surface of a secured area; coupling a motor of the movable barrier operator to a movable barrier, the movable barrier operator having a power rating indicative of a minimum power to be supplied to the movable barrier operator in order for the movable barrier operator to move the movable barrier; and connecting an external power supply for the movable barrier operator to an electrical outlet, the external power supply including a plurality of outputs configured to supply electrical power to the movable barrier operator, each of the outputs having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the output provides that is less than the power rating of the movable barrier operator.

(50) In yet another embodiment, the method further comprises connecting wires of the outputs of the external power supply to the movable barrier operator. In an embodiment, the method further comprises coupling a connector of the external power supply to an interface of the movable barrier operator to electrically connect the outputs of the external power source to the movable barrier operator. In an embodiment, the outputs of the external supply include a plurality of wires enclosed in a single jacket. In an embodiment, the method further comprises securing the jacket to a wall of the secured area. In an embodiment, the method further comprises mounting the movable barrier operator to the surface includes mounting the movable barrier operator to the surface at a distance of greater than six feet from the electrical outlet. In an embodiment, the method further comprises connecting the external power supply for the movable barrier operator to the electrical outlet includes connecting a plug of a cord of the external power supply to the electrical outlet, the cord

configured to provide AC electrical power to AC-to-DC converter circuitry of the external power supply, the AC-to-DC converter circuitry configured to provide DC electrical power to the outlets of the external power supply.

(51) Uses of singular terms such as “a,” “an,” are intended to cover both the singular and the plural, unless otherwise indicated herein or clearly contradicted by context. The terms “comprising,” “having,” “including,” and “containing” are to be construed as open-ended terms. It is intended that the phrase “at least one of” as used herein be interpreted in the disjunctive sense. For example, the phrase “at least one of A and B” is intended to encompass A, B, or both A and B.

(52) While there have been illustrated and described particular embodiments of the present invention, it will be appreciated that numerous changes and modifications will occur to those skilled in the art, and it is intended for the present invention to cover all those changes and modifications which fall within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A movable barrier operator system comprising: a motor configured to be coupled to a movable barrier and move the movable barrier between open and closed positions, the motor having a Class 1 motor power rating; an external power supply configured to connect to an electrical outlet, the external power supply including a plurality of outputs each having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the output supplies, the power rating of the outputs are all Class 2; and a combiner circuitry operatively connected to the plurality of outputs of the external power supply and the motor, the combiner circuitry configured to combine power received from the plurality of outputs of the external power supply and provide the motor with power that was combined from the plurality of outputs of the external power supply.
2. The movable barrier operator system of claim 1, further comprising: a monitoring circuit operatively connected to the external power supply and configured to detect a fault condition of any of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply.
3. The movable barrier operator system of claim 1, wherein the outputs are combined to supply the Class 1 input to the motor.
4. The movable barrier operator system of claim 1, wherein the plurality of outputs comprises three outputs.
5. The movable barrier operator system of claim 1, wherein the motor is part of a movable barrier operator, and wherein the movable barrier operator further comprises an interface to which the outputs are connected.
6. The movable barrier operator system of claim 5, wherein the external power supply comprises a connector, wherein each output is electrically coupled to the connector through a wire, and wherein the connector is coupled to the interface to electrically couple the external power supply to the motor.
7. The movable barrier operator system of claim 1, further comprising a backup battery.
8. The movable barrier operator system of claim 7, wherein the backup battery is coupled to a battery charger that receives power from the combiner circuitry when the motor is not being operated to charge the backup battery when the backup battery is not fully charged.
9. The movable barrier operator system of claim 8, wherein the battery charger is configured to monitor a status of the backup battery and provide power from the combiner circuitry only when the backup battery is not fully charged.
10. The movable barrier operator system of claim 1, wherein the movable barrier operator system comprises a jackshaft operator.
11. A power delivery system comprising: a high-power device having a power rating indicative of a minimum power to operate the high-power device; an external power supply configured to connect to one or more electrical outlets, the external power supply including a plurality of outputs each

having a power rating indicative of a maximum power each output supplies; a combiner circuitry configured to combine power from the plurality of outputs of the external power supply and provide the high-power device with power that at least meets the power rating indicative of the minimum power to operate the high-power device; and a monitoring circuit configured to detect a plurality of fault conditions of any of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply.

12. The power delivery system of claim 11, wherein the monitoring circuit is configured to detect the plurality of fault conditions, the plurality of fault conditions comprising at least one of: improper connection of one or more of the plurality of outputs; excess voltage or current load on one or more of the plurality of outputs; insufficient voltage or current load on one or more of the plurality of outputs; and failure of one or more of the plurality of outputs.

13. The power delivery system of claim 11, wherein the power rating of the high-power device is a first power rating and the power rating of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply are a second power rating, and wherein the first and second power ratings are different from one another.

14. The power delivery system of claim 13, wherein the first power rating is greater than the second power rating.

15. The power delivery system of claim 11, wherein the monitoring circuit comprises: the combiner circuitry; one or more blocking diodes configured to prevent power from traveling from one output of the plurality of outputs from the external power supply to another output of the plurality of outputs of the external power supply; and one or more microprocessors coupled to one or more voltage current monitors configured to detect the plurality of fault conditions.

16. The power delivery system of claim 11, wherein the high-power device power rating is Class 1 and the power ratings of the outputs of the external power supply are all Class 2.

17. The power delivery system of claim 11, wherein the monitoring circuit includes a microprocessor configured to: sequentially test the outputs of the external power supply by energizing the output being tested and deenergizing the outputs not being tested; and determine a fault condition in response to one of the outputs not being tested providing energy to the combiner circuitry.

18. A power delivery system comprising: a power supply configured to connect to an electrical outlet, the power supply including a plurality of outputs each having a power rating indicative of a maximum power the output supplies; a combiner circuitry that combines power from the outputs of the power supply and is configured to provide the combined power to a motor configured to be coupled to a movable barrier to move the movable barrier between open and closed positions, wherein a power rating for each outlet of the power supply is less than a motor power rating of the motor; and a monitoring circuit configured to detect a fault condition of any of the outputs of the power supply.

19. The power delivery system of claim 18, wherein the motor power rating is Class 1 and the power ratings of the outputs of the power supply are all Class 2.

20. The power delivery system of claim 18, wherein the monitoring circuit is configured to detect the fault condition, the fault condition comprising at least one of: improper connection of one or more of the plurality of outputs; excess voltage or current load on one or more of the plurality of outputs; insufficient voltage or current load on one or more of the plurality of outputs; and failure of one or more of the plurality of outputs.
